

Mini-interview: your background and job

Worksheet

- A** Prepare for a mini-interview. Decide which of the following questions you want to answer and fill in any gaps with your own personal information. Then work with a partner to discuss how you would answer them.

- 1 I notice that your university/higher education course was in _____.
 - Which part of the course did you enjoy most? Why did you like that subject?
 - Did you do a project in the final year? Can you tell me about that?
- 2 I see that after university/higher education you worked in several jobs.
 - One of your first jobs was as a _____ (job) in _____ (company). Can you tell me about that?
- 3 I see that in your previous job you worked as a _____ (job) in _____ (company).
 - Can you tell me about that? What exactly did you do there?
 - What did you learn from that job?
 - Why did you stay so long/so little time in that company?
 - Why did you leave?
- 4 So, your current job is as a _____ (job) in _____ (company).
 - Can you tell me a little about the company? What exactly do you do there?
 - What have you learnt in your current job?
 - What personal and professional skills have you developed?
 - How have you kept up to date with new techniques?
 - What experience do you have of _____ technology?
 - How would you describe your management style?
 - Why do you want to leave your current job?
- 5 I see that you are currently unemployed.
 - Why are you not working? How have you spent your time while you've been unemployed?
 - Have you had other interviews? Why do you think you weren't successful?
- 6 Tell me something about yourself.
 - What do you do in your free time? What hobbies and interests do you have?
 - What are your strong points?
 - What are your weak points?
 - Can you work under pressure? Can you give me an example?
 - Are you a persistent and determined person? Can you give me an example?
 - What have been your greatest achievements during your career?
 - Can you describe an important challenge in your life?
 - Can you describe an important change in your life?
 - What are your career objectives? Where do you see yourself three years from now?

- B** Work with a new partner and have a formal mini-interview.

Interviewee Before you start, give your CV/Resume and this worksheet to your interviewer. Make sure your interviewer knows which questions you have prepared.

Interviewer Use the questions you are given. Listen carefully and ask follow-up questions.